

Jamaica

Country Report (Institutional)

Region: Americas • Capital: Kingston • Currency: JMD • ISO: JAM / JM

FRESHNESS & DATA STAMPS

Report generated	June 4, 2026
Platform refresh	Jun 3, 2026
Macro data as-of	2025
Trade data as-of	2024
Markets coverage	Not covered
Policy last reviewed	Jun 4, 2026

Values shown in this report are sourced and time-stamped. Platform refresh is not a markets feed. Fields without structured backing are labeled Not covered.

SOUVERA SIGNAL SCAN

Emerging · Caribbean gateway

Confidence: **Medium**

- FDI net inflows \$950M (2025)
- GDP growth 2.8% (2025)
- Inflation 6.2% (2025)

At-a-glance (12 months)

- **Base case:** Jamaica is a \$19B Caribbean economy at a digital inflection point, offering opportunities across tourism, digital infrastructure, and mining/energy transition.
- **Top risks:** Jamaica's investment landscape requires balanced assessment of macro, political, and operational risks. Hurricane exposure and tourism concentration are real but manageable through insurance, diversification, and... (continued in body)
- **Watchpoints (90d):** Governance & Stability

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For informational purposes only. Verify material facts independently before decisions.

Dashboard

Jamaica is profiled with macro data as-of 2025 and platform refresh on file.

Canonical GDP growth is 2.8% with nominal GDP \$19.0B; inflation 6.2%; FDI \$950M.

Figures below are drawn from structured series and the policy registry — not headline display strings.

Macro Snapshot

Indicator	Latest	Prior	As-of	Source
GDP (nominal USD)	\$19.0B	\$17.8B	2025	Source: World Bank
GDP growth	2.8%	3.1%	2025	Source: World Bank
Inflation (CPI)	6.2%	7.0%	2025	Source: World Bank
FDI net inflows	\$950M	\$900M	2025	Source: World Bank
FX (local/USD)	159.00	157.00	2025	Source: World Bank

MARKETS COVERAGE

Not covered

Platform refresh timestamp is not a markets feed. Rates, curves, and spreads are not included in this edition.

TRADE

EXPORTS

\$5.8B

IMPORTS

\$6.6B

Trade as-of: 2024

Partner	Share %
United States	27%
China	13%
Trinidad & Tobago	11%

Market Access (Registry)

Framework	Status	Source	Last reviewed
CARICOM	Under review	CARICOM	Jun 4, 2026
CBI	Under review	USTR	Jun 4, 2026

External Sector

EXTERNAL SECTOR

Not covered

Current account, reserves, and remittances series not yet populated for this country.

Risk Heatmap

Domain	Level
Macro	Moderate
Fiscal	Not covered
External	Not covered
Political	LOW-MODERATE
Operational	Moderate

Sector Leaderboard

Sector	Strength	Growth	Attractiveness
Fintech & Digital Finance	72	78	76
Energy & Renewables	65	75	70
Agriculture & Agribusiness	68	65	67
Mining & Alumina	78	55	68
Logistics & Trade	75	68	72

Executive Summary

Jamaica is a \$19B Caribbean economy at a digital inflection point, offering opportunities across tourism, digital infrastructure, and mining/energy transition.

Jamaica's investment landscape requires balanced assessment of macro, political, and operational risks. Hurricane exposure and tourism concentration are real but manageable through insurance, diversification, and USD-linked revenue streams.

This executive summary uses canonical macro stamps and the institutional policy registry; items without structured backing render as Not covered.

Base / Upside / Downside

BASE CASE	UPSIDE	DOWNSIDE
- Jamaica is a \$19B Caribbean economy at a digital inflection point, offering opportunities across tourism, digital infrastructure, and mining/energy transition. - GDP growth 2.8% (2025) - Signal: Emerging · Caribbean gateway	- FDI acceleration above \$950M - Sector leaders maintain attractiveness scores >80 - Policy frameworks align with USTR/AU/ECOWAS registry entries where listed	- Inflation re-acceleration above 6.2% - FX volatility beyond structured series - Political/security shocks (see Risk)

What changed since last structured year

- GDP growth moved -0.3 pp (2024→2025).
- Nominal GDP scale +7% (2024→2025) in USD terms (USD values reflect FX/base effects).

Key watchpoints (30–90d)

- Currency Volatility
- Governance & Stability
- Policy registry refresh (AGOA/AfCFTA/ECOWAS)

Geography & Demographics

Jamaica occupies a strategic position within Americas economic geography — a market profile designed for investors who may not yet know the country's location, scale, or demographic advantage.

Jamaica sits in the Caribbean Basin — a nearshore corridor with preferential U.S. trade linkages (CBI/CARICOM), tourism-driven services exports, and growing digital-services nearshoring in capital cities.

The administrative capital is Kingston, which hosts core policy institutions, while commercial hubs often concentrate financial services, logistics, and technology clusters. Understanding this urban hierarchy helps investors site operations, hire talent, and engage regulators.

With a population of 2.8M and economic output of \$19.0B, Jamaica offers scale sufficient for consumer markets, labor-intensive manufacturing, and services expansion — subject to infrastructure and market-access conditions detailed later in this profile.

Fact	Value	Note
Region	Americas	Caribbean Basin — nearshore corridor with CBI/CARICOM U.S. trade linkages and tourism-mining diversification.
Capital	Kingston	Administrative and policy center
Currency	JMD	Official unit of account
ISO Codes	JAM / JM	International identifiers
Economic Scale	\$19.0B	GDP (2025) — Caribbean's third-largest English-speaking economy
Population	2.8M	People (2025) — English-speaking workforce with US time-zone alignment
Digital Hub	Kingston	Nearshore Capital — Submarine cables, Jam-Dex CBDC pilot, growing BPO cluster
Growth	2.8%	GDP Growth (2025) — Tourism recovery + digital services expansion

Political Environment

Political environment assessment for Jamaica — governance quality, institutional stability, and security conditions that affect investment timelines and capital repatriation.

Jamaica's political landscape spans governance, policy continuity. For international investors, political risk is not abstract: it determines contract enforcement, license continuity, tax policy stability, and the security of personnel and assets on the ground.

Governance & Stability (LOW-MODERATE): Stable democracy with peaceful transitions and low geopolitical risk relative to the Caribbean region. Policy continuity on digital transformation and tourism investment. Souvera monitors election cycles, security hotspots, and governance indicators alongside macro data because political shocks often precede currency and FDI volatility.

English-speaking common law jurisdiction with established regulatory frameworks for financial services and tourism investment

LOW-MODERATE

Governance & Stability

Stable democracy with peaceful transitions and low geopolitical risk relative to the Caribbean region. Policy continuity on digital transformation and tourism investment.

- Mature democratic institutions
- Regional stability anchor

Sources: see Appendix

Economic Overview (Macro & Monetary)

Economic overview for Jamaica — macro scale, growth trajectory, and price stability based on World Bank, BOJ, STATIN.

This section summarizes Jamaica's macroeconomic performance using official and multilateral data sources (World Bank, BOJ, STATIN). Indicators include GDP scale and growth, inflation, foreign direct investment, population, and exchange-rate dynamics — the core variables that drive sovereign risk pricing and corporate valuation multiples.

With BOJ tightening supporting price stability amid tourism-led recovery. Investors should read headline metrics alongside the multi-year trajectory in the indicator panel — single-year snapshots can mislead when reforms or currency moves create base effects.

Jamaica's GDP expanded from \$15.0B (2019) to \$19.0B (2025), a 27% increase over five years. Recovery was driven by tourism rebound, remittance inflows (\$3.5B+ annually), and digital services nearshoring in Kingston.

Year	GDP USD	Growth	Inflation	FX
2019	\$15.0B	-8.3%	5.2%	—
2020	\$16.0B	5.7%	5.9%	142.00
2021	\$18.8B	6.4%	10.3%	145.00
2022	\$21.4B	2.7%	6.5%	152.00
2023	\$22.0B	-0.5%	5.4%	155.00
2024	\$17.8B	3.1%	7.0%	157.00
2025	\$19.0B	2.8%	6.2%	159.00

- GDP growth: -8.3% (2019) → 2.8% (2025)
- GDP scale: \$15.0B → \$19.0B
- FDI inflows ~\$950M (2025) — nearshore and tourism investment

External & Trade

Trade and sector analysis for Jamaica — how the country connects to global and regional markets, and where export-oriented investment can capture preferential access.

Jamaica recorded approximately \$5.8B in goods exports and \$6.6B in imports in the latest Souvera trade registry refresh. Bilateral flows, CBI/CARICOM access, nearshore corridor. Bilateral concentration matters: top partners include United States (27%), China (13%), Trinidad & Tobago (11%) shape currency earnings, supply-chain dependence, and geopolitical exposure.

Trade performance is only half the story. Preferential frameworks — AGOA, AfCFTA, ECOWAS, CBI, or CARICOM — determine whether manufactured and agricultural exports enter major markets at reduced or zero duty. Investors should align product mix and origin rules with active agreements.

Sector scorecards below rank Strength, Growth, and Attractiveness (S/G/A) for each vertical Souvera tracks. These scores synthesize terminal data, editorial intelligence, and comparative regional benchmarks — helping investors prioritize sectors before committing diligence resources.

Metric	Value
Exports	\$5.8B
Imports	\$6.6B
As-of year	2024

HS export/import composition: Not covered in this edition.

Regional frameworks

Agreement	Summary
CARICOM	15 member states · CSME integration · regional services market The Caribbean Community supports regional trade in goods and services among member states, with CSME integration for labor and capital mobility.
CBI	Caribbean Basin Initiative · preferential U.S. market access The Caribbean Basin Initiative offers preferential U.S. market access for eligible exports from participating Caribbean Basin countries.

Sectors & Scorecards

The Souvera sector scorecard ranks verticals on **Strength** (current competitive position), **Growth** (expansion trajectory), and **Attractiveness** (investment appeal). Scores run 0–100. Higher scores indicate stronger positioning relative to regional peers. Use this section to shortlist sectors before deep due diligence.

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Trade performance is only half the story. Preferential frameworks — AGOA, AfCFTA, ECOWAS, CBI, or CARICOM — determine whether manufactured and agricultural exports enter major markets at reduced or zero duty. Investors should align product mix and origin rules with active agreements.

Sector	S	G	A	Teaser
Fintech & Digital Finance	72	78	76	Caribbean fintech hub with BOJ-regulated digital payments, JAM-DEX CBDC pilot, a
Energy & Renewables	65	75	70	Transitioning from oil dependence to LNG and renewables, with solar and wind pro
Agriculture & Agribusiness	68	65	67	Export-oriented agriculture focused on Blue Mountain coffee, cocoa, and spices,
Mining & Alumina	78	55	68	Bauxite and alumina production anchored by long-established operations and integ
Logistics & Trade	75	68	72	Caribbean transshipment hub anchored by Kingston Freeport Terminal and strategic

Methodology: See Appendix — Scorecard Methodology. Confidence: medium.

Investment Opportunity

Investment opportunity assessment for Jamaica — caribbean digital gateway at a tourism and nearshore inflection point.

Jamaica offers multiple entry channels across technology, agriculture, infrastructure, energy, and services. The pillars below summarize where patient capital has the highest structural tailwinds — based on Souvera terminal intelligence, not generic emerging-market templates.

Each opportunity area includes specific sub-themes (fintech, value-add agriculture, power, logistics) with quantified market gaps where available. Investors should cross-reference Risk Assessment and Market Access sections before sizing commitments.

Digital Infrastructure & Fintech — Caribbean Digital Gateway

Jamaica leads the English-speaking Caribbean in submarine cable connectivity, cloud readiness, and fintech interoperability via the Jam-Dex CBDC pilot. Kingston is emerging as the region's nearshore delivery hub for North American firms.

Tourism & Hospitality — Premium Segment Recovery

World-renowned destination with luxury segment growth, cruise port expansion, and sustainable tourism investment. Arrivals recovering with 15%+ higher average spend per visitor versus 2019.

Mining & Energy Transition — Bauxite + Renewables Pipeline

Bauxite/alumina sector transitioning toward renewable energy and green hydrogen potential. Energy diversification reduces import dependence and supports ESG-aligned industrial investment.

Risk Assessment

Risk assessment for Jamaica — caribbean risk profile with imf anchor and tourism diversification mitigants.

Institutional investors require explicit risk taxonomy: macro (currency, inflation, debt), political (governance, security), operational (power, logistics, talent), and sector-specific exposures. Jamaica's profile below follows this structure with severity ratings and mitigants for each factor.

No emerging market is risk-free. The objective is risk-adjusted return — identifying where mitigation tools (insurance, local partners, phased deployment, hard-currency revenue) bring exposures within acceptable bounds for your mandate.

MACRO RISKS

MODERATE Currency Volatility

JMD exchange rate volatility persists (~157 JMD/USD, 2025). IMF Extended Fund Facility anchors fiscal discipline. Tourism and remittance inflows (\$3.5B+) provide natural USD hedges.

MODERATE Inflation

Inflation at ~7.0% (2025) with BOJ tightening supporting price stability. Lower volatility profile than larger emerging markets.

MODERATE Debt Sustainability

Debt-to-GDP elevated but improving under IMF program. Fiscal reforms targeting primary surplus maintenance and expenditure rationalization.

POLITICAL RISKS

LOW-MODERATE Governance & Stability

Stable democracy with peaceful transitions and low geopolitical risk relative to the Caribbean region. Policy continuity on digital transformation and tourism investment.

OPERATIONAL RISKS

MODERATE Hurricane Exposure

Seasonal hurricane risk to tourism and coastal infrastructure (June–November). Resilient building codes and insurance markets mitigate catastrophic loss.

MODERATE Infrastructure Gaps

Rural connectivity and grid reliability variable outside Kingston corridor. PPP models and renewable self-generation reduce dependency.

MODERATE Tourism Concentration

Tourism contributes ~30% of GDP — cyclical exposure to global travel trends and weather events. Digital services diversification mitigates.

Mitigation toolkit: PRI/MIGA coverage, FX hedging, phased deployment, local JV structures — align to mandate.

Signal Scan & Souvera Edge

Souvera Signal Scan synthesizes macro momentum, FDI, inflation, and sector leadership into an actionable badge.

Investment Window: Jamaica offers a 24-36 month positioning window as digital infrastructure scales and tourism diversification accelerates.

Differentiators vs static country briefs: live data refresh, trade policy legislative tracking, sector S/G/A scorecards, and quota-managed AI custom briefs grounded in this same intelligence foundation.

Emerging · Caribbean gateway

Confidence: **Medium** — derived from structured macro coverage (2025).

- FDI net inflows \$950M (2025)
- GDP growth 2.8% (2025)
- Inflation 6.2% (2025)

Model limits

Signal scan synthesizes available macro and sector inputs; it is not a trading signal. Where series are incomplete, confidence is downgraded and drivers use canonical metrics only.

Souvera edge

- Live Signal Scan — updated with macro and sector inputs, not annual PDF refresh cycles
- Market Access Registry — AGOA restoration/suspension, AfCFTA, ECOWAS, CBI, CARICOM in one view
- Trade Policy Intelligence — legislative tracker and export opportunity mapping
- Terminal-to-PDF parity — this report mirrors the seven country intelligence tabs
- AI Custom Briefs — query-driven reports grounded in Souvera data (Business+ quota)

Appendix: Methodology

Scorecards rank Strength (position), Growth (trajectory), and Attractiveness (investment appeal) on 0–100 scales versus regional peers.

Signal scan combines macro momentum, FDI, inflation, and sector leadership with explicit confidence tiers.

Data quality: fields without structured backing render as Not covered; preflight blocks contradictory narratives and unresolved template tokens.

Data & Methodology — providers

- **World Bank** — Macro indicators (GDP, growth, inflation, FDI, population) via WDI.
- **IMF** — Fiscal and external-sector series where ingested (SDMX / AREAER).
- **UN Comtrade** — Bilateral goods trade flows and partner concentration.
- **USTR** — AGOA and U.S. preferential program eligibility.
- **AU** — AfCFTA continental trade framework status.
- **ECOWAS** — West African regional integration and market-access protocols.

Appendix: Glossary

This glossary defines key institutions, economic indicators, and trade programs referenced in this Country Profile.

IMF (International Monetary Fund)	A global institution that monitors economic stability, provides policy advice, and lends to countries facing balance-of-payments crises. IMF forecasts and program reviews are widely cited in sovereign and corporate credit analysis.
World Bank	Multilateral development bank focused on poverty reduction and infrastructure. Its Doing Business successor indicators, country economic updates, and project pipelines inform sector entry timing.
GDP (Gross Domestic Product)	The total value of goods and services produced within a country in a given period. GDP scale indicates market size; GDP growth signals expansion or contraction of economic activity.
FDI (Foreign Direct Investment)	Cross-border investment where a foreign entity establishes lasting interest in a local enterprise (greenfield, joint venture, or acquisition). FDI inflows signal international confidence in a market.
CPI / Inflation	Consumer Price Index measures average price changes for household goods and services. Elevated inflation erodes purchasing power and can pressure interest rates and currency stability.
FX / Exchange Rate	The price of one currency in terms of another (e.g., local currency per U.S. dollar). Exchange-rate movements affect import costs, export competitiveness, and the dollar value of local earnings.
AGOA (African Growth and Opportunity Act)	U.S. trade preference program granting eligible African countries duty-free access for thousands of product lines. Eligibility is subject to annual U.S. Presidential review and can be restored or suspended.
AfCFTA (African Continental Free Trade Area)	Pan-African agreement creating a single market of 54 countries and 1.3 billion consumers, with phased tariff elimination. Enables regional manufacturing hubs and cross-border supply chains.
ECOWAS (Economic Community of West African States)	Regional bloc of 15 West African nations promoting free movement of goods, services, and people. Membership provides duty-free regional trade and harmonized investment protocols.
CBI (Caribbean Basin Initiative)	U.S. preferential trade program for Caribbean Basin countries, allowing duty-free entry for many goods exported to the United States when eligibility criteria are met.
CARICOM (Caribbean Community)	Political and economic union of Caribbean states. The CSME (Caribbean Single Market and Economy) component supports regional labor mobility and services trade.
MIGA (Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency)	World Bank Group agency providing political risk insurance against expropriation, currency inconvertibility, and breach of contract — commonly used to de-risk greenfield FDI.

Appendix: Sources & Disclosures

World Bank, IMF, UN Comtrade, Souvera Curated Intelligence

Market-access registry (summary)

- CARICOM: Under review — Source: CARICOM · Last reviewed: Jun 4, 2026
- CBI: Under review — Source: USTR · Last reviewed: Jun 4, 2026

Appendix: Data coverage & limitations

- External sector: not covered — Current account, reserves, remittances (WDI)
- Fiscal / public debt: not covered — IMF WEO — debt and fiscal balance (% of GDP)
- Markets (rates/curves/spreads): not covered — Platform refresh is not a markets feed
- FX regime / capital controls: not covered — IMF AREAER document extraction planned
- Governance indicators (WGI/CPI): not covered — WGI/CPI ingestion planned

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